

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Problem-Solving and Data Analysis	One-variable data: Distributions and measures of center and spread	Easy

Question

The table below shows the high and low temperatures in Houston, Texas, during a five-day period.

Temperatures in Houston, Texas (degrees Fahrenheit)					
	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
High temperature	73	56	62	75	81
Low temperature	49	37	41	54	63

What was the mean low temperature, in degrees Fahrenheit, during the five-day period?

Answer

- A. 48.8
- B. 49
- C. 59
- D. 59.1

Correct Answer: A

Rationale

Choice A is correct. The mean low temperature can be calculated by finding the sum of the low temperatures for all the days shown in the table, $49 + 37 + 41 + 54 + 63 = 244$, and then dividing the sum by the number of days the temperature was recorded, $244 \div 5 = 48.8$.

Choice B is incorrect. This may be the result of choosing the median rather than calculating the mean. Choices C and D are incorrect and may be the result of calculation errors.